IEEE RAS · VITC STUDENT CHAPTER | OFFICIAL PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK | THU 15 OCT 2026 · VIT CHENNAI

8 HOURS × 2 ROUNDS × 1 BUILDER × ₹30K IN PRIZES × FREE ENTRY

ISSUE #BO-001 × THE BRIEF

SOMETHING'S BROKEN. YOU'RE ON CALL.

Bugged Out! is an 8-hour solo software buildathon run by the IEEE Robotics & Automation Society, VITC Student Chapter, with the VIT Chennai Office of Students' Welfare. You get two rounds, two separate challenges and no teammates to hide behind. Every line you ship is yours.

The morning round runs in the AB3 gallery classrooms, 601 and 701. After lunch the event moves to the VOC Auditorium for the second round. Both challenges will be revealed on the day of the event, so there is nothing to prepare except your setup. Entry is free and the event is open to builders from any college.

TICKET SUMMARY	STATUS: OPEN
EVENT	Bugged Out!
FORMAT	Solo · software · in person
DATE	Thursday, 15 Oct 2026
HOURS	8:00 AM – 4:45 PM
ROUNDS	2 separate challenges
MORNING	AB3 Gallery Classrooms 601 & 701
AFTERNOON	VOC Auditorium, Admin Block, 5th floor
ENTRY	Free · open to all colleges
PRIZES	Worth ₹30,000

FIND IT. FIX IT. SHIP IT. ALONE.

CHECK-IN	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	TOP 20
8:00 AM	**9:00 - 12:30**	**2:00 - 4:00**	**AFTER 4 PM**
AB3 Gallery Classrooms 601 & 701	Submit on the MLH portal	VOC Auditorium	Panel round

STACK TRACE × THURSDAY, 15 OCTOBER

THE DAY, LINE BY LINE

Times in red are hard deadlines. The portal closes on the minute, so **submit early rather than at the last second.**

8:00 AM DOORS OPEN	**Check-in** Check in at the registration desk and complete your MLH check-in before you sit down. Keep your ID card on you.		AB3 GALLERY CLASSROOMS 601 & 701
9:00 AM BUILD STARTS	**Round 1 begins** The Round 1 challenge is revealed. The Hack2Skills PromptWars page is shared straight after, and every participant registers on it.	BUILD	AB3 GALLERY CLASSROOMS 601 & 701
12:00 PM PORTAL OPENS	**Round 1 submissions open** Start submitting on the MLH portal now. Don't wait for the final half hour.	SUBMIT	MLH PORTAL
12:30 PM HARD DEADLINE	**Round 1 submissions close** Submission is mandatory. You leave for lunch only after your Round 1 entry is in.	DEADLINE	MLH PORTAL
12:30 - 2:00 BREAK	**Lunch** Take a real break. Carry your laptop and charger with you, because the room changes after lunch.		–
VENUE CHANGE · AB3 GALLERY CLASSROOMS 601 & 701 → VOC AUDITORIUM, ADMIN BLOCK, 5TH FLOOR			
2:00 PM SHARP	**Round 2 begins** A separate challenge from Round 1, with two hours on the clock. The start is not delayed for latecomers.	BUILD	VOC AUDITORIUM
By 3:00 PM PRIZE ELIGIBILITY	**Google One form and stickers** Complete the Google One form with the Event Code to become eligible for the cash prize. Stickers are handed out too.	REQUIRED FOR CASH PRIZE	VOC AUDITORIUM
4:00 PM HARD DEADLINE	**Final submissions close** Round 2 entries are locked at 4:00 PM sharp. Nothing is accepted after the cut-off.	DEADLINE	VOC AUDITORIUM
After 4:00 EVALUATION	**Top 20 revealed, panel round** Sponsors reveal the top 20 from the submission evaluations. Those participants present to the panel.	TOP 20	VOC AUDITORIUM
By 4:45 PM WRAP	**MLH goodies and close** Selected participants receive MLH goodies. The cash prize result is announced later in the WhatsApp group.		VOC AUDITORIUM · WHATSAPP GROUP

TWO PATCHES × ONE BUILDER

TWO ROUNDS. TWO CHALLENGES.

The rounds are independent. Round 2 is a new challenge, not a continuation of your Round 1 build, so plan your morning to finish something complete by 12:30.

01 MORNING BUILD

9:00 AM – 12:30 PM · 3.5 HOURS

The longer of the two rounds. The challenge is revealed at 9:00 AM, and you have the rest of the morning to scope it, build it and get it working end to end.

VENUE	AB3 Gallery Classrooms 601 & 701
OPENS	Challenge revealed at 9:00 AM
SUBMIT	MLH portal, from 12:00 PM
CLOSES	12:30 PM, hard deadline

> Register on the Hack2Skills PromptWars page as soon as it's shared at the start of this round.

02 AFTERNOON SPRINT

2:00 PM – 4:00 PM · 2 HOURS

Shorter and faster. A fresh challenge after lunch in the auditorium. Two hours rewards a tight scope and a working demo over an ambitious half-build.

VENUE	VOC Auditorium, 5th floor
OPENS	2:00 PM sharp
SUBMIT	Link shared at kickoff
CLOSES	4:00 PM, hard deadline

> Finish the Google One form before 3:00 PM so it doesn't eat into your last hour.

CLASSIFIED **PROBLEM STATEMENTS WILL BE REVEALED ON THE DAY OF THE EVENT**

Each round's brief lists the requirements, data and exactly what to submit. Read it twice before you write any code.

TEST SUITE × HOW YOU'RE SCORED

JUDGED ON WHAT WORKS

Every challenge is judged on the same seven areas, weighted high, medium or low. Each brief sets the exact test metric for that challenge.

CRITERION	WEIGHT
Core performance How well the solution does the main job on held-out data or hidden test scenarios, using the metric the brief names.	HIGH
Correctness and constraints No broken rules: capacity limits, deadlines, timestamps and every hard constraint in the brief are respected.	MEDIUM
Robustness Behaviour on messy input: noise, missing values, changed conditions and edge cases you didn't tune for.	MEDIUM
Explainability and evidence Every output traces back to its evidence. Verified facts are kept apart from guesses, and certainty is never overstated.	MEDIUM
Engineering and reproducibility A clean pipeline, clear setup steps, reliable data handling and results a judge can run again.	LOW
Usability and demo A person can use it without you explaining every screen, and the demo shows it working.	LOW
Real-world relevance A clear target user, a believable workflow and a benefit you can defend.	LOW
HIGH · MEDIUM · LOW	**7 AREAS**

SCORING SAFEGUARDS

One test set for everyone.
All submissions are scored on the same hidden scenarios with the same method.

No credit for cheating the constraints.
A better score that comes from breaking a rule in the brief earns nothing for that gain.

Claims need proof.
Results are judged on what your evaluation shows, not on what the pitch promises.

Late means missing.
A submission after the deadline is not scored.

The top 20 from the submission scores move on to the panel round after 4:00 PM.

LINT RULES × WHAT PASSES, WHAT FAILS

THE RULES

PASSES

- ☑ **AI coding tools**
  ChatGPT, Claude, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and similar are fully allowed in both rounds.
- ☑ **Public libraries and frameworks**
  Any open-source library, framework, API or SDK.
- ☑ **Pre-trained models**
  Publicly available models may be used and fine-tuned during the event.
- ☑ **UI component kits**
  Base component libraries are fine. The product logic must be yours.
- ☑ **APIs and cloud services**
  Hosted APIs, free tiers and cloud deployments are all fine.

FAILS

- ☒ **Teammates or outside help**
  This is a solo event. Nobody else writes, designs or debugs your entry.
- ☒ **Pre-built projects**
  All project code is written on the day. You can't submit something you built earlier.
- ☒ **Skipping a submission**
  Submitting is mandatory in both rounds.
- ☒ **Hardware builds**
  This is a software buildathon. No boards, sensors or kits.
- ☒ **Skipping check-in**
  You must check in at the desk and on MLH before you start building.

BOUNTY × OPEN TO EVERYONE

PRIZES WORTH ₹30K

The competition is public, so participants from outside VIT can win the cash prize too. Being eligible takes one extra step on the day.

PRIZE POOL

₹30K

Cash prize result announced later in the WhatsApp group. MLH goodies go to selected participants.

BECOME ELIGIBLE FOR THE CASH PRIZE

1. Bugged Out! has partnered with Google One to activate free student plans. The form link is shared after lunch.
2. Create your Google One account through that link. An account made any other way doesn't count.
3. Submit the form with the Event Code announced at the venue, before 3:00 PM.

NOTE Skip this and you can't win the cash prize, however well you score.

PRE-FLIGHT × BEFORE YOU LEAVE HOME

SET UP BEFORE 8 AM

BRING

- ☐ **Laptop**, fully charged. It's your only tool today.
- ☐ **Charger and an extension box.** Sockets are shared and fill up fast.
- ☐ **ID card.** College ID, needed at check-in.
- ☐ **Registration confirmation**, on your phone or printed.
- ☐ **Water and snacks.** Two rounds and a venue change make for a long day.
- ☐ **A notebook and pen**, for sketching your scope before you code.

HAVE READY

- ☐ **MLH account**, for check-in and Round 1 submission.
- ☐ **Hack2Skills account**, to register on PromptWars at 9:00 AM.
- ☐ **GitHub**, signed in on your laptop, with git working.
- ☐ **Your dev environment**: editor, language runtimes and package managers installed and tested.
- ☐ **AI tools** logged in, so you don't lose ten minutes to a sign-in screen.
- ☐ **A Google account** you can use for the Google One form.

SIDE QUESTS × BEYOND THE BUILD

NOT ONLY CODE

PHOTOBOOTH	STICKERS	MLH GOODIES	WHATSAPP GROUP
Grab a shot between rounds. Tag the chapter when you post.	Handed out in the auditorium by 3:00 PM.	For the participants selected after the panel round.	Scan the QR shown at the venue. Results and updates are posted there.

KNOWN ISSUES × RESOLVED

FREQUENTLY ASKED

BO-01 **Can I team up with someone?**

No. Bugged Out! is a solo software buildathon. You build, debug and submit on your own in both rounds.

BO-02 **Who can take part?**

Anyone who registered. The event is public, so students from other colleges can compete and win the cash prize. Entry is free.

BO-03 **Can I build a hardware project?**

No. Bugged Out! is software only, so every entry has to run on your laptop or in the cloud.

BO-04 **What are the problem statements?**

They will be revealed on the day of the event, at the start of each round. Each round is a separate challenge.

BO-05 **Can I use ChatGPT, Claude or Copilot?**

Yes. AI coding tools are allowed in both rounds. The work you submit still has to be built during the event.

BO-06 **Do I have to submit both rounds?**

Yes. Submission is mandatory in each round. For Round 1, you can only leave for lunch once you've submitted.

BO-07 **Where do I submit?**

Round 1 goes on the MLH portal between 12:00 and 12:30 PM. The Round 2 submission link is shared when the round starts at 2:00 PM.

BO-08 **How do I qualify for the cash prize?**

Create a Google One account through the form link shared at the event, and submit the form with the Event Code before 3:00 PM.

BO-09 **Where exactly is the venue?**

Check-in and Round 1 are in the AB3 gallery classrooms, 601 and 701. After lunch, Round 2 and the panel round are in the VOC Auditorium, Admin Block, 5th floor.

BO-10 **When are results out?**

The top 20 are revealed after 4:00 PM and go to the panel round. The cash prize result is announced later in the WhatsApp group.

DEPENDENCIES × POWERED BY

OUR PARTNERS

SPONSOR	SPONSOR	SPONSOR	PLATFORM PARTNER
Qualcomm	**Hack2Skills**	**adaption.ai**	**MLH**

CONTACT

STUCK ON A BUG?

Call or message a student coordinator for anything about check-in, venues or submissions.

STUDENT COORDINATORS		FACULTY COORDINATORS
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